The Newton Property Tax Worksheet

The formula, the bill calendar, and a first-year budget

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Start here

Everyone quotes Newton's tax rate. Few people explain what it means for the home you're actually looking at, when the real bill shows up, or what to do if the value looks wrong.

This worksheet helps you budget for property tax on a Newton home: the formula, Newton's bill calendar, and what to check before and after you buy. It ends with two pages to fill in: the tax math for a specific home, and a first-year ownership budget.

Read it once now, then keep it open while you compare homes. The math takes about a minute per property.

This edition uses Newton's FY2026 rate. Want the FY2027 version when Newton sets the rate? Ask me and I'll send it.

Step 1: The formula

Annual property tax = assessed value ÷ 1,000 × tax rate

The tax rate is in dollars per $1,000 of assessed value. Assessed value is the value the city puts on the home for tax purposes. It isn't the same as the price you pay (see Step 2).

Newton residential rates

- FY2026 (July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026): $9.69 per $1,000 of assessed value
- FY2025: $9.80 per $1,000
- FY2027: not yet set as of October 2026. Newton sets each year's rates after the City Council's tax classification hearing, held in mid-November in recent years (November 17, 2025 for FY2026 and November 18, 2024 for FY2025). Check the Assessing Department page on newtonma.gov for the current rate.

Example

- Assessed value: $1,000,000
- $1,000,000 ÷ 1,000 = 1,000
- 1,000 × $9.69 = $9,690 per year, before any exemptions
- Plus Newton's Community Preservation Act (CPA) surcharge of 1% on the real estate tax: about $97 on this example, before any exemptions. Ask Newton Assessing how it applies to the home you're considering.

You'll run this for your own home on the worksheet page at the end.

Step 2: Use the right value

- Massachusetts assesses property as of the January 1 before each fiscal year. Newton's FY2026 values reflect January 1, 2025.
- Assessors must update values to full and fair cash value every year.
- So the assessed value on a listing can lag the current market.

Check it for each home

- Look up the home's assessed value in the City of Newton's online Assessor's Database, linked from the Assessing Department page on newtonma.gov.
- Compare it to the list price or your offer.
- Run the formula twice: once with the assessed value, once with your expected purchase price.

Jared's take

Budget using the higher of the two numbers. Values are updated every year from market sales, so a low assessment may not stay low. Budgeting with the higher number covers you either way. I'd rather you be pleasantly surprised than squeezed in year two.

Step 3: Newton's tax bill calendar

Newton bills quarterly. Each fiscal year runs July 1 to June 30.

1. **August 1.** Preliminary estimate.
2. **November 1.** Preliminary estimate.
3. **February 1.** The "actual" bill: certified value, rate, and total tax.
4. **May 1.** Actual bill.

When a due date falls on a weekend or holiday, the installment is due the next business day (City of Newton Treasury, Tax Information).

What that means for you

- Estimates first: the first two bills are estimates, each based on the prior year's tax. The February and May bills settle up the full year's tax, minus what's already been paid.
- Buying this fall? The February 1, 2027 bill is expected to be the first one with Newton's FY2027 rate.
- Abatement window: an abatement is a reduction in your tax, most often because the assessed value is too high. If you think the value is too high, the application is generally due by the due date of the first actual bill, typically February 1. If actual bills go out late, the deadline can move later, so check the date printed on your bill.
- Keep paying: filing for an abatement doesn't pause your payments. If your yearly tax is more than $5,000, your payment must reach the collector by each due date to keep your right to appeal to the Appellate Tax Board (Secretary of the Commonwealth, sec.state.ma.us).

Jared's take

Treat the February bill's due date (typically February 1) as two deadlines in one: the payment and the abatement application. Open that bill the day it arrives and check the assessed value. If it looks wrong, call Newton Assessing that week. Don't wait for the last few days.

Step 4: If you just bought (or are about to)

- Confirm with the City of Newton Treasury that tax bills will be mailed to you at your new address. Not receiving a bill doesn't change the due date.
- Ask your attorney how property taxes will be adjusted between you and the seller at closing.

- Ask your lender whether your property taxes will be paid through an escrow account (an account your lender or loan servicer funds from your monthly payment and uses to pay the tax bills for you).
- Put the abatement deadline on your calendar: typically February 1, but check the date printed on your first actual bill.
- Ask Newton Assessing whether you qualify for any exemptions, and the deadline to apply.

Newton in context

From the Massachusetts Division of Local Services (DLS) Municipal Databank:

- Newton FY2026 average single-family assessed value: $1,762,337
- Newton FY2026 average single-family tax bill: $17,077, the 13th highest in Massachusetts in the DLS report for FY2026
- For comparison, FY2025: average single-family assessed value $1,664,692 and average single-family tax bill $16,314

Newton's rate went down from FY2025 to FY2026 ($9.80 to $9.69), but the average single-family bill went up by $763 because values rose. The rate alone doesn't tell you what you'll pay.

These DLS figures cover single-family homes only; condominiums aren't included. Your number depends entirely on the specific home's assessed value, which is why Step 1 matters more than any average.

Jared's take

Two homes at the same price can have very different yearly costs once you add assessed value, heating type, and condo fees. Run the budget on your top two homes side by side before you decide which one to fight for.

The Tax Math Worksheet and the First-Year Budget are on the next pages.

Tax Math Worksheet (copy one per home)

Blank lines are for your own numbers. Use the current rate: $9.69 for FY2026, or Newton's FY2027 rate once it's set.

The home

- Home: _____
- Current rate: $_____ per $1,000

With the assessed value

- Assessed value: $_____
- ÷ 1,000 = _____
- × current rate = $_____ per year

With your expected purchase price

- Expected purchase price: $_____
- ÷ 1,000 = _____
- × current rate = $_____ per year

The number to budget with

- The higher of the two: $_____ per year
- CPA surcharge (1% of the yearly tax): $_____ per year
- (Tax + CPA) ÷ 12 = $_____ per month (for budgeting only)

First-Year Budget (copy one per home)

Fill this in for each home you're seriously considering. Get quotes where you can.

The home

- Home: _____

Yearly

- Property tax (Tax Math Worksheet, the higher number): $_____
- CPA surcharge (1% of the property tax): $_____
- Homeowners or condo unit insurance (get a quote): $_____
- Water and sewer (ask the seller for recent bills): $_____
- Heating and cooling (ask the seller for 12 months of bills): $_____
- Electricity and other utilities: $_____
- Maintenance and repairs reserve: $_____

Monthly

- Condo fee, if any: $_____
- What the condo fee covers (heat, water, insurance, snow?): _____

One-time, first year

- Immediate repairs from the inspection: $_____
- Moving and setup: $_____
- Condo special assessment, if any is planned: $_____

Total

- Yearly items, added up: $_____
- Condo fee × 12: $_____
- Total yearly ownership cost (before your mortgage) (add the two lines above): $_____
- One-time costs, first year: $_____

Questions to ask

Newton Assessing

- What's this property's current assessed value, and when was it last updated?
- Do I qualify for any exemptions, and what's the deadline?

Your lender

- Will my property taxes and insurance be paid through escrow?

Your attorney

- How will this year's taxes be split with the seller at closing?

The listing agent (ask in writing, through your agent)

- Can the seller share the last 12 months of utility and water and sewer bills?
- Are there any pending abatement applications or exemptions on the current bill?

Your next step

Send me the address of any Newton home you're considering. I'll pull its current assessed value, run the tax math with you, and show you how it compares to recent sales nearby.

Want the FY2027 version of this worksheet when Newton sets the rate? Ask me and I'll send it.

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Sources

Checked October 18, 2026, unless noted.

- City of Newton Assessing Department, Tax Rate (Current and Prior Year) (newtonma.gov): FY2026 residential rate of $9.69 per $1,000 and FY2025 rate of $9.80 per $1,000.
- City of Newton, FY2026 Classification Hearing materials, November 17, 2025, and FY2025 classification hearing, November 18, 2024 (newtonma.gov): when each year's rate is set.
- Massachusetts Division of Local Services, Municipal Databank (dlsgateway.dor.state.ma.us): no FY2027 figures for Newton as of October 18, 2026, supporting "not yet set as of October 2026".
- City of Newton Treasury Department, Tax Information (newtonma.gov): quarterly due dates of August 1, November 1, February 1, and May 1; the next-business-day rule; preliminary and actual bills; and late or missing bills.
- City of Newton Community Preservation Program (newtonma.gov): CPA adopted in 2001 with a 1% surcharge on real estate taxes. The $97 figure is 1% of the $9,690 example.
- City of Newton Assessor's Database, linked from the Assessing Department page (newtonma.gov): assessed values by property.
- Massachusetts Division of Local Services, Assessment Administration (mass.gov): January 1 assessment date and annual full and fair cash value.
- Massachusetts Division of Local Services, Municipal Databank, Average Single Family Tax Bill report (dlsgateway.dor.state.ma.us), data current as of October 18, 2026: Newton FY2026 and FY2025 average single-family values and bills, and the FY2026 rank.
- Secretary of the Commonwealth, Citizen Information Service, Property Tax Abatement (sec.state.ma.us): the abatement deadline, and the rule that when the yearly tax is more than $5,000, payment must reach the collector by each due date to keep the right to appeal to the Appellate Tax Board.
- Massachusetts Department of Revenue, State Tax Form 128, Application for Abatement of Real Property Tax (mass.gov): filing doesn't stop collection, and paying on time keeps appeal rights.
- The $9,690 example and the $763 difference are arithmetic on the figures above.

Disclaimer

Jared Cohen, REALTOR® | eXp Realty. Licensed real estate salesperson in Massachusetts.
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